Energy Drinks in The Gym

RESEARCH POSTER

Assumption and prediction

Assumption and prediction:

- Most Gen Z gym-goers prefer energy drinks with bold lettering and bright/grungy designs in masculine colors.
- I predict that when I go to the gym, I'll find energy drinks such as Ghost or C4.

What I did

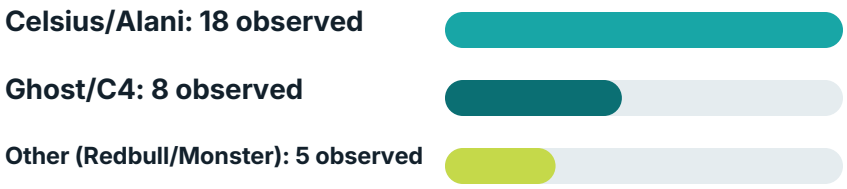
What I did

- Asked directly: I asked people in the gym what energy drinks they preferred and why
- Observation: I walked around the gym and wrote down what energy drinks people had: minimalist ones such as Alanis, grungy ones such as C4 and Ghost, and others like Red Bull or Monster
- Read what exists; I looked up studies and did research online

What I found from observations

What I found

- From the observations of going to the gym 3 days for 2 hours each, these were the following tallies
- Celsius/Alani: 18 observed
- Ghost/C4: 8 observed
- Other (Redbull/Monster): 5 observed
- One noticeable distinction is that the other category was mostly made up of older people
- Celsius/Alani was mostly girls, but also, shockingly, a bunch of guys made up this observation
- The ghost/c4 was mostly your average gym guy who wears gym apparel



What I found from direct responses

What I found
From asking directly, here are some responses I got

- “I don’t like the flavors Ghost/C4 has, and Alani feels way lighter and doesn’t make me feel like I have acid in my stomach”
- “When I was shopping, the Ghost/C4 didn’t really stand out to me and kind of looked unappealing”
- “I’ve always been drinking C4 since I started going to the gym and never really tried anything else”

What I found from articles and studies

What I found

- Articles and studies found that the “hyper-masculine signifiers” are starting to shift away, and the market is now pushing “holistic wellness and functional health cues” now

“Changing Consumer Demands in the Energy Drinks Industry.” Mintel, www.mintel.com/insights/food-and-drink/changing-consumer-demands-in-the-energy-drinks-industry/. Accessed 5 Sept. 2026.

What I Believe Now

What I Believe Now

- Rewritten Assumption: Gen Z gym-goers favor subtle and minimalist drinks that prioritize wellness over hyper-masculine gym aesthetics
- Next question: Does the time of day affect what energy drinks you see? Do morning people drink more hyper-masculine than later in the day?